

Parks Board Meeting, June 16, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BpWVCVuJOgY
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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held prior to the regular meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called to order the Muncie Parks and Recreation Board meeting on Tuesday, June 16th [00:00:44](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mark Ervin, Sam Paris, CJ Johnson, Ashley Wright, Brad Marshall
 - **Members Absent:** *None noted*
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall (implied by call to order/actions)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:47](#). The board also noted a staffing transition in the office [00:01:15](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Approval of the May minutes [00:01:43](#). Approved by Voice Vote [00:01:53](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:01 Superintendent Report**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Malone provided updates on his first two weeks back. Highlights included National Parks Kid Day turnout at Westside Park, the 6-week summer intern employment program serving 50 kids, dugout renovations at Westside Park, restroom status and neighborhood talks at Riverview Park, door installations and lighting quotes at Heekin Park, tree cleanup and field maintenance at Thomas Park, and goal replacement work at McCollough Park. Board members asked clarifying questions regarding splash pad drainage, shade issues, and ball diamond maintenance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:16:10 Event Approval: Back-to-School Backpack and Supply Giveaway**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone / Brenda McCoy
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal for an annual back-to-school backpack and supply giveaway at Heekin Park on August 8th from 11:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Board noted it is a historically well-attended program with no issues.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:17:21](#).
- **00:17:41 Event Approval: Historical Re-enactment at Westside Park**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone / David West
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a re-enactment event at Westside Park on September 28th from 8:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m. with Gaston Police providing security. Board members raised questions regarding the anticipated attendance numbers (listed vaguely as 50 to 200) and the specifics of the security plan.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled to the July agenda for further clarification and application review [00:19:24](#).
- **00:19:51 Event Approval: Grissom School Back-to-School Bash**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request from Grissom School to host a back-to-school bash at Cooley Park on August 3rd from 3:00 p.m. to 7:00 p.m. (rain date August 5th). The event uses school security and requests open restrooms.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:22:33](#).
- **00:23:07 Event Approval: Back to Muncie Homecoming (2027)**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to secure McCulloch Park for the city-wide "Back to Muncie Homecoming" event scheduled for July 28th to August 1st, 2027. The large-scale event requests in-kind donations of amenities (cabins, bleachers, stages, trash cans, port-a-potties) and Electric City Security. Board members agreed to tentatively hold the date while requesting a detailed schedule, expected

participation numbers, and a comprehensive security plan in coordination with the Muncie Police Department and the Mayor's office.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tentatively approved to hold the date, pending future detailed presentations [00:26:29](#).
- **00:37:33 Event Approval: Juneteenth Basketball Details & Community Events**
 - **Presenter:** Charles Strong / Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of additional activities for the previously approved Juneteenth event, including local high school alumni basketball games (Muncie Central vs. Southside, Muncie vs. Anderson) and the "Battle of the 765" six-team basketball tournament at the parks on Friday and Saturday, alongside youth games, face painting, inflatables, Delaware County Championship Wrestling, a gospel celebration, and a wellness village organized with IU Health and 42 nonprofit partners.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational and supplemental approval; accepted by consensus.
- **00:40:55 Prairie Creek Reservoir Report**
 - **Presenter:** Taylor Beard
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Taylor Beard provided updates on park mowing, landscaping, dock repairs, and preparations for Ron Bonham Day (July 3rd) and the Ironman race (July 11th). He reported that the beach passed its first health inspection with zero violations, boat launch bathrooms are temporarily out of order awaiting plumbing repairs, and remote door locking is functioning.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:45:54 Event Approval: Prairie Creek Shelter Rental for Celebration of Life**
 - **Presenter:** Taylor Beard
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Shelter rental request for July 17th for a celebration of life expecting 45 to 55 people. Because the count exceeds recommended shelter capacity, it falls under event guidelines requiring board approval.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:47:24](#).
- **00:47:31 Event Approval: USA Bassin Fishing Tournament**
 - **Presenter:** Taylor Beard / Shannon
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resubmission/clarification for the USA Bassin fishing tournament event scheduled for September 12th (following a prior discussion in December).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:49:53](#).
- **00:54:04 New Business: Second Harvest Mini Food Mart at Cooley Park**
 - **Presenter:** Shannon
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request by Second Harvest to bring a mini mobile refrigerated food truck unit to Cooley Park once a month to provide free food access, accompanied by Ball State University graduate student health screenings

(diabetes checks, blood pressure, etc.). Board members praised the health screening component and discussed coordinating with neighborhood associations.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote for a one-year term, contingent on working out dates/times with Carl Malone and the Southside neighborhood 00:58:41.
 - **00:59:28 Old Business / Venue Change: Gus Macker Basketball Tournament**
 - **Presenter:** Aaron / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to amend the previously approved in-kind donation of park resources (bleachers) due to a change of venue for the Gus Macker tournament to Wapahani High School.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:00:16.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:30:20 Julius Anderson:** Spoke as the Riverview block captain regarding the long-awaited completion and upcoming June 26th ribbon-cutting ceremony for Riverview Park. He shared historical background on the park dating back to 1955, expressed gratitude to Superintendent Malone and the board for visiting the site to address full-court basketball and restroom access concerns, and outlined neighborhood efforts to help maintain and monitor the park.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Board noted upcoming events, including the Riverview Park ribbon-cutting on June 26th at 11:00 a.m. 00:36:46, Ron Bonham Day on July 3rd 00:41:14, and the Ironman race on July 11th 00:42:06. Flatland is scheduled to provide a full project update at the July meeting 00:53:46.
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn made and carried by voice vote 00:01:26.
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